

9TH EDITION • 2024

2024 JavaScript Rising Stars

Top Projects and Ecosystem Shifts

Methodology: GitHub stars added in 2024 • Source: Best of JS curated list

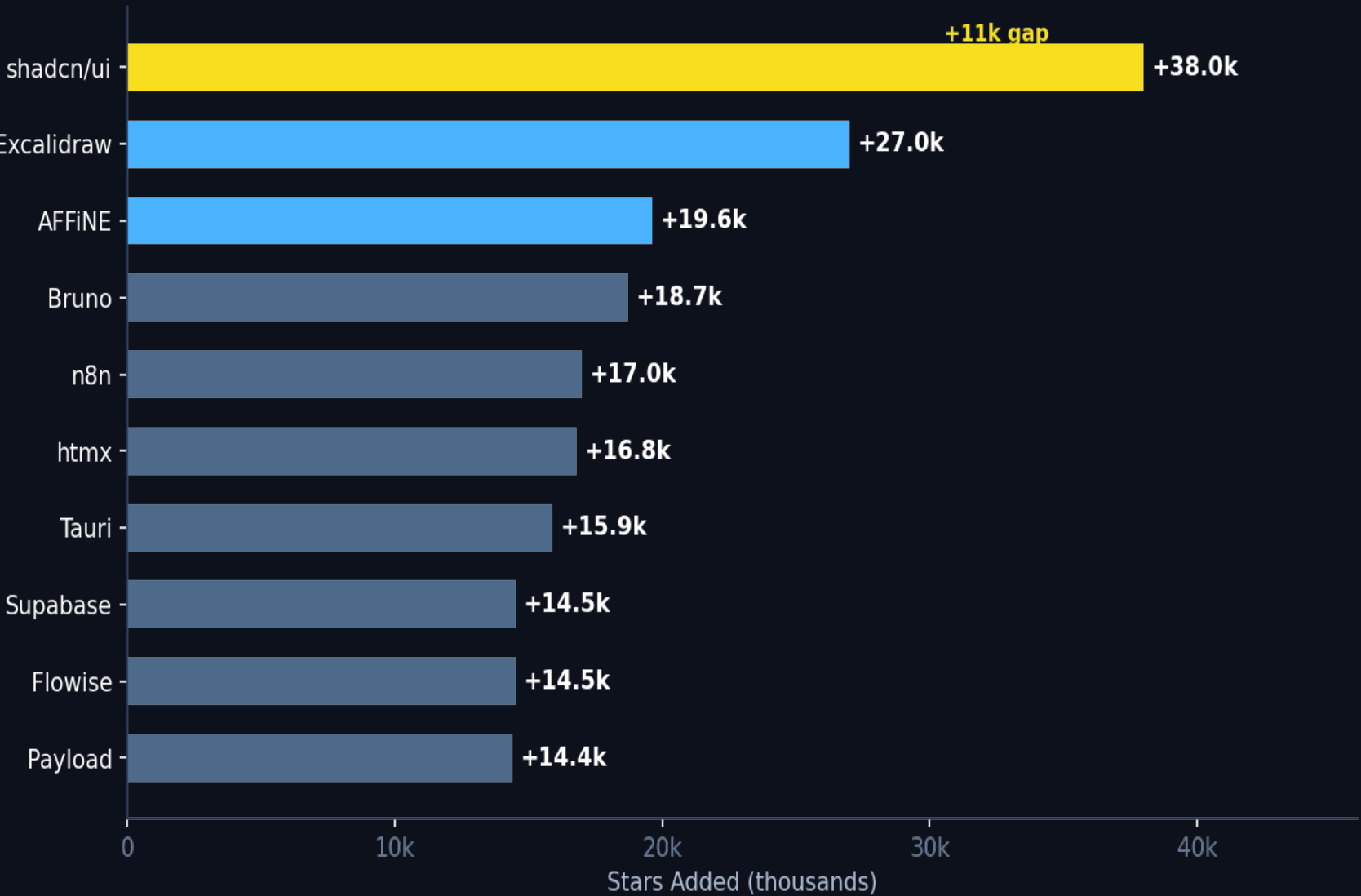
For: Frontend Engineers & Engineering Managers

#1
shadcn/ui

+38k stars in 2024

shadcn/ui Leads Overall with +38k Stars

Followed by Excalidraw (+27k) and AFFiNE (+19.6k)



2× Back-to-Back

shadcn/ui wins for the 2nd consecutive year

4 of 10 are AI tools

n8n, Flowise, Supabase, AFFiNE lead AI wave

Tooling Diversity

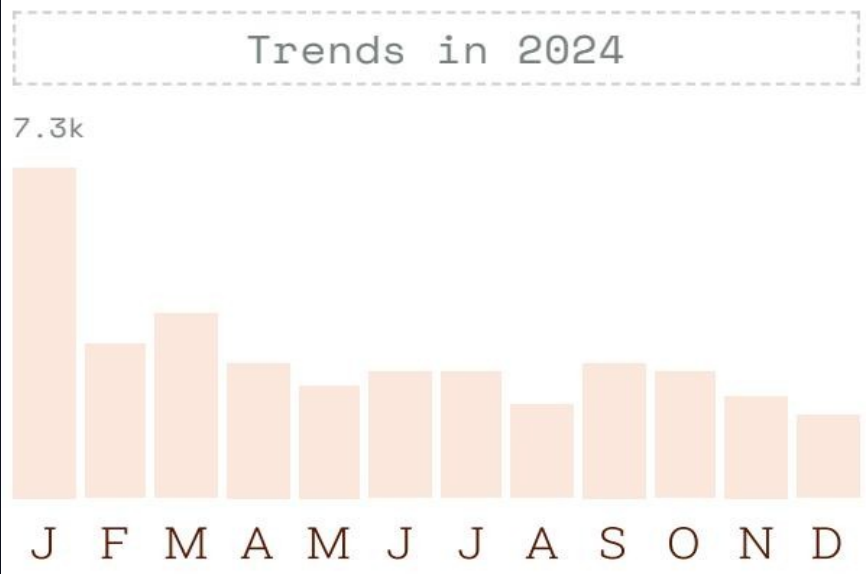
API testing, automation, desktop, backend all charted

shadcn/ui: Copy-Paste Components Win Again

Second consecutive #1 · 77.5k total stars · Created January 2023



Jan peak: +7.3k



Monthly star additions 2024 (peak: Jan +7.3k)

Key 2024 Additions

Charts

Powered by Recharts

Themes

CSS variable generation

Blocks

Layout collections

≡ Sidebar

Responsive component

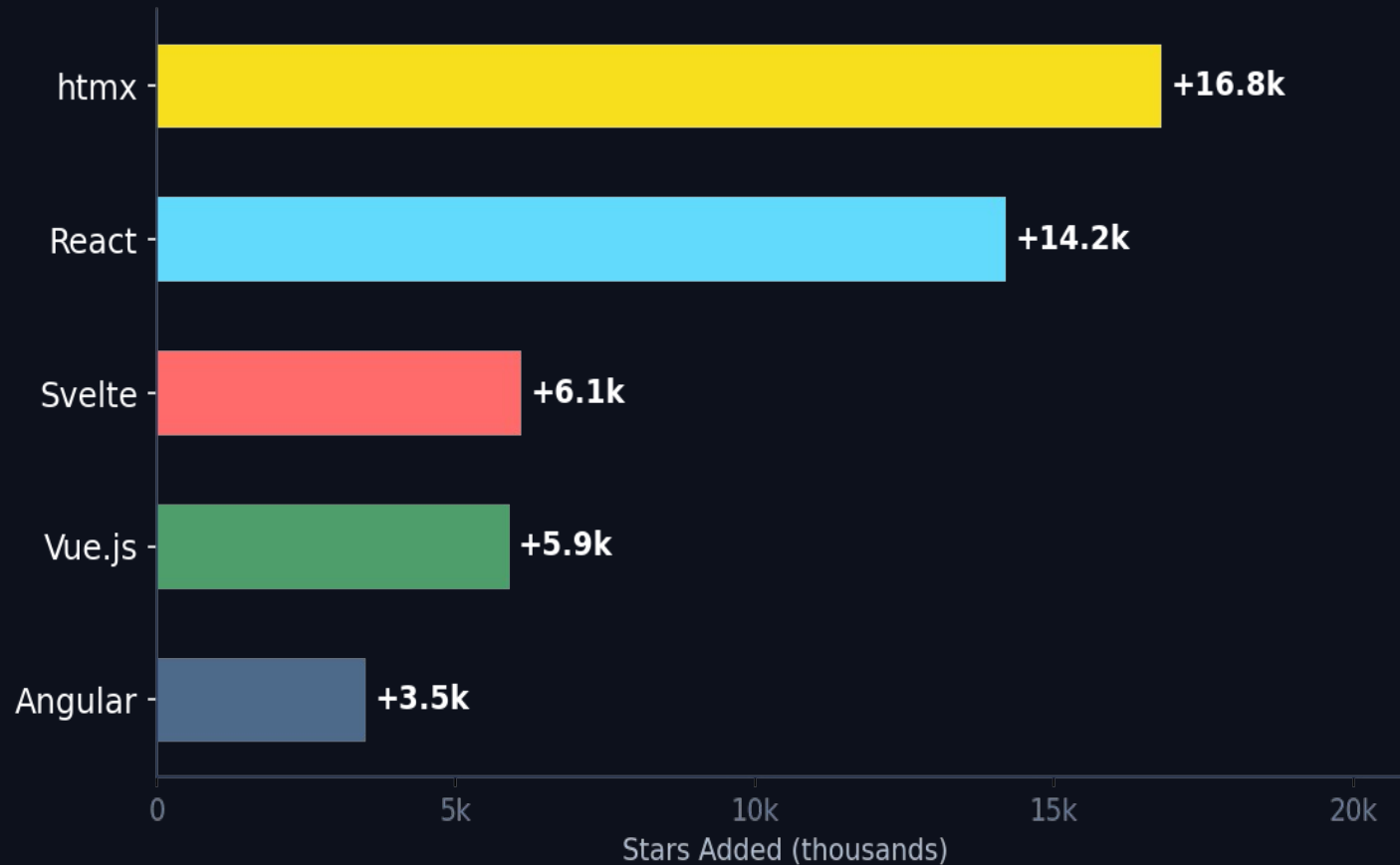
New CLI

Next.js, Remix, Vite,
Laravel & monorepos

Insight: CLI registry spawned derivative libs (Motion-Primitives, Magic UI) · v0 AI integration further boosted adoption

htmx Overtakes React as #1 Front-end Framework

Stars added in 2024 across the major front-end frameworks



htmx #1

Extends HTML via hx-* attributes.
Server-driven, zero-JS philosophy.
Rose from #2 in 2023.

React 19 Launches

After 3 years: Server Components,
Server Functions, Custom Elements,
new hooks & form actions.

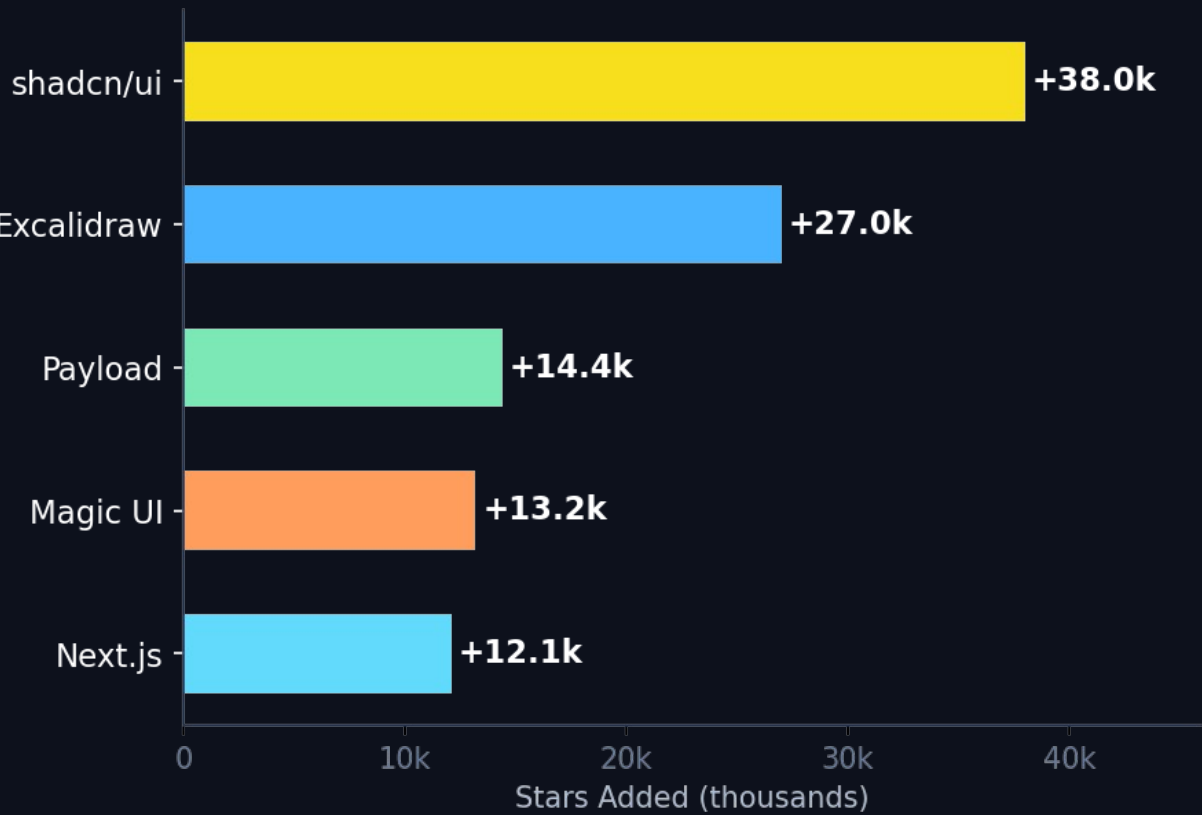
Svelte 5 'Runes'

Explicit reactive state declarations.
Highest positive opinion in
State of JS survey.

React is evolving from a library into "a specification for frameworks" (Robin Wieruch) — Next.js, Remix, and others interpret its primitives differently.

React Ecosystem: shadcn/ui, Excalidraw, and Payload Dominate

Top 5 React ecosystem projects by stars added in 2024



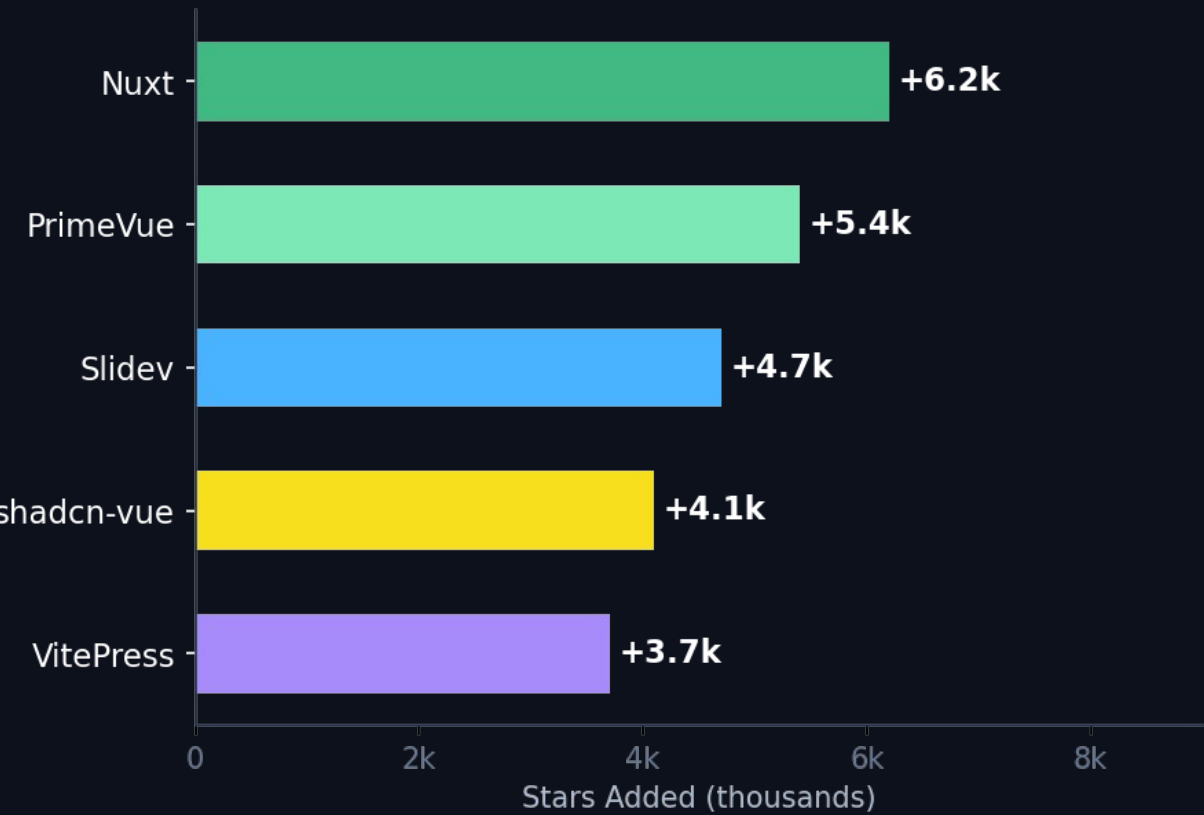
Project Highlights

shadcn/ui +38.0k
Copy-paste UI components
Excalidraw +27.0k
Hand-drawn diagrams whiteboard
Payload +14.4k
Open-source fullstack Next.js
Magic UI +13.2k
Animation-first components
Next.js +12.1k

React is becoming a framework specification: Server Components & Server Functions in React 19 mean frameworks like Next.js and Remix interpret primitives differently. React Compiler continues improving perf & DX.

Vue Ecosystem Flourishes: Nuxt, PrimeVue, and Slidev Lead

Vue ecosystem top 5 by stars added · Vue 3.5 reactivity overhaul



Project Highlights

Nuxt +6.2k	Full-stack Vue meta-framework
PrimeVue +5.4k	Rich UI component library
Slidev +4.7k	Presentation slides for devs
shadcn-vue +4.1k	shadcn/ui ported to Vue
VitePress +3.7k	

Vue 3.5 reworked its reactivity system with the lighter alien-signals approach (already in main branch). PrimeVue & shadcn-vue signal a confident, maturing UI library ecosystem. — Daniel Roe, Nuxt core lead

AI Tools, Desktop Apps, and Browser Innovation Shape 2024

Cross-cutting themes from the 2024 Rising Stars data

AI-Powered Tools

- n8n +17.0k — Workflow automation with native AI
- Flowise +14.5k — Visual LLM flow builder
- Supabase +14.5k — Open-source BaaS backend
- AFFiNE +19.6k — Notion + Miro with AI

4 of the top 10 overall projects have significant AI capabilities

Desktop & Native

- Tauri +15.9k — Desktop/mobile apps via web frontend
- Lighter than Electron, Rust-powered core
- Cross-platform: Windows, macOS, Linux, iOS, Android
- 2024: Tauri v2 released

Web-tech desktop apps maturing beyond Electron

Browser-Based Innovation

- PGLite — Full Postgres running via WebAssembly
- WebVM — A complete VM running in the browser
- Demonstrates expanding browser compute capabilities
- Opens door to offline-first, zero-server architectures

WebAssembly & browser APIs pushing what's possible client-side

Key Takeaways: What 2024 Tells Us About JavaScript's Future

5 actionable findings pointing toward 2025

01 Component ownership beats imports

shadcn/ui's copy-paste model (77.5k total stars) proves developers want owned, customizable code — not black-box npm packages. Expect more 'registry' style libraries in 2025.

02 HTML-first is a serious architecture

htmx overtook React as the #1 framework by stars. Server-driven, low-JS approaches are gaining real credibility alongside SPA frameworks.

03 React is becoming a framework spec

React 19's Server Components & Server Functions mean frameworks interpret React primitives differently. React is evolving into an ecosystem standard, not just a library.

04 AI integration is table stakes

4 of the top 10 projects (n8n, Flowise, Supabase, AFFiNE) have deep AI capabilities. In 2025, AI-readiness will be expected, not optional.

05 Vue's ecosystem signals maturity

Wave of high-quality UI libraries (PrimeVue, shadcn-vue) plus Vue 3.5's alien-signals reactivity overhaul signal a confident, competitive Vue ecosystem.

Looking to 2025 →

Watch: AI-native tooling, Tauri v2 adoption, React compiler GA, Vue alien-signals perf gains, htmx + server framework combos.